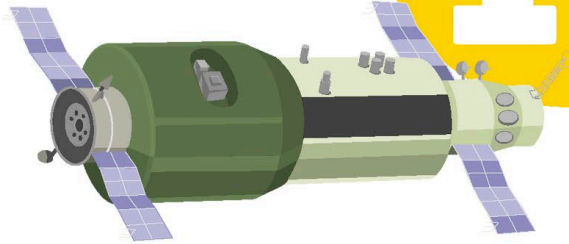


April

19

## 1971 First space home

The first-ever space station, *Salyut 1*, was launched into Earth's orbit as part of the Soviet Union's space programme. It stayed in space for 175 days and circled Earth nearly 3,000 times.



## American Revolution 1775

The first battles of the US War of Independence between Britain and its colonies took place at Lexington and Concord in Massachusetts, in present-day USA.



## Born this day

**1946 Duygu Asena**, Turkish journalist and civil rights champion. She campaigned for equality and wrote about injustices towards women.

## 1968 Snowmobile trek

After journeying for 42 days on snowmobiles, US explorer Ralph Plaisted and his teammates Walter Pederson, Gerald Pitzl, and Jean-Luc Bombardier became the first people to reach the North Pole by travelling over the surface of the Arctic ice.

## Also on this day

**1987** The USA's favourite cartoon family, the Simpsons first appeared in a series of short episodes on the *Tracey Ullman Show*.

**1987** The UK's first medical unit for HIV and AIDS patients was opened by Diana, Princess of Wales, in London, UK.

**2018** Swaziland's King Mswati III changed the country's name to eSwatini to celebrate 50 years of independence from British rule.

